

Nehemiah's Leadership: Building Under Fire

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

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zisemi'e. Ab irdi Susa ab biltsigna yinebir nebere kab ziberese midri abohagotat'u rihiqu. Bizikhone alemawi memzeni Nihimya betsihwo'yu zinebere. I'wut wihus ab mich'ot zinebere nebere — gin mich'ot kem zigiltselu tsewi'ita malet ayikonen.)

*ketema bizey kibret bizey halewa ab mengo hagerai bizey bota zela ketema'ya. Nay
Amlak hizbi ab hisret yinebru neberu nikulu tselai teqali'om nigorebabiti'om
melagetsi. Iti zena ni'Nihimya kem akalawi miwqa'e haremo.)*

meweda'ita ma'iqobu ayineberen; nay mejemreya milash'u'yu zinebere. Nime'altai — minalbat nisemunat — nefsu nab Amlak kab mifisas wets'ai hanti'wun ayigeberen.)

Scene 4

[PICTURE: Nehemiah praying with hands raised, tears streaming down his face. Above him, translucent images show the broken walls of Jerusalem, scattered stones, and charred gates. His prayer is intense and deeply personal — a man wrestling with God over the fate of his people. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Nehemiah's prayer — recorded in chapter one — is a masterclass in how leaders should pray. He began with worship: "Lord, the God of heaven, the great and awesome God." He didn't start with his request; he started with God's character. Then he confessed — not just the people's sins, but his own: "I confess the sins we Israelites have committed, including myself and my father's family." True leaders don't stand apart from their people's failures; they own them. Finally, he reminded God of His promises — not because God forgets, but because speaking God's promises back to Him anchors our faith in His faithfulness. Nehemiah prayed BEFORE he planned. This is the foundation that separates godly leadership from mere ambition.

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(Nay Nihimya tselot — ab mi'iraf hade zitetsahife — merahiti bikemey kitsliyu kem zilewomu zila'ale timhirtiyu. Bi'amilkho jemiru: "Goyta Amlak semay abiy'n zefrihi'n

Amlak." Bilimena'u ayjemereren; biBahiryat Amlak'yu jemiru. Dihri'u te'amene — nay hizbi hati'at tiray zeyikone nay geza'e ri'isu'wun: "Nihna deqi Isra'el zigebernayo hati'at ane ba'iley'n bet aboy'n hawisna ina'aminku." Haqenya merahiti kab widqet hizbom ayifleyun; yiweniniwo. Ab meweda'ita nay Amlak tesfatat azekhakhero — Amlak sile ziris'i zeyikone nay Amlak tesfatat nab'u mizrab imnetna ab imunnet'u sile zihizo. Nihimya qidmi miwtan tseleye. Izi nay Amlak merihnet kab tera shewhat zifeliyo meseret'yu.)

*Nihimya senbede — qidmi nigus guahiy mir'ay kem zeyigbet wey kem zeyimunnnet
kitrgom yikhil bimot ziqtsa'e'wun. Gin hadega wesede ni'Iyerusalem zinebero tsor
kab firhi nigus sile zi'abeye. Izi merihnet ziftenelu himot'yu: mizrab waga zihatit gin
siqita zeyitsawer zikhewn iwan.)*

*zikhone seb yigelits. Dihri'u limena'u qerebe — bigirihnet wey bisimi'it zeyikone
bistrategikawi lik'inet: nab Iyerusalem nay mikhad fiqad bi'awrajat nay wihus mihilaf
debdabetat'n nimihnats kab nay nigus chaka intseyt'n. Nihimya ni'arba'ite awarih
tsehyu nebere gin sinifna ayineberon. Mermiru hasibu tedaliyu nebere. Haqenya
imnet bidembedembe mishab malet ayikonen — kitwtin kelekha mitslay'n kititsli
kelekha miwtan'n malet'yu.)*

Scene 7

[PICTURE: Nehemiah riding on horseback at night through the broken ruins of Jerusalem. Moonlight reveals massive gaps in the crumbled stone walls, charred gate timbers scattered on the ground. He carries a small torch, carefully examining the damage. Only a few trusted companions follow at a distance. The scene is somber and investigative. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

After the long journey to Jerusalem, Nehemiah didn't announce himself with fanfare. He waited three days, then went out at night with only a few trusted men to inspect the walls. He told no one what God had put in his heart to do for Jerusalem. This nighttime inspection reveals strategic wisdom: before you cast vision publicly, you must understand the reality privately. Nehemiah needed to see the damage with his own eyes — to assess the scope of the work, identify challenges, and develop a credible plan. Leaders who announce grand visions without doing their homework inspire momentary excitement but eventually lose credibility. Nehemiah inspected before he inspired.

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(Dihri newih gu'izo nab Iyerusalem Nihimya bijahira ayite'arqen. Seleste me'alti tsenihu dihri'u leyti mis wihudat zi'aminomu sebat tiray mendeq kifitish wetse. Amlak ni'Iyerusalem kigber ab libu zigebero nimaniam ayinegeron. Izi nay leyti mifitash strategikawi tibeb yigelits: biwegi'awi ra'iy qidmi mizrigah biwilqi haqi kitirdi'e aleka. Nihimya gud'at bigeza'e aynu kiri'i adleyo — aqen srah kigimgim bidhotat kileleli

*zi'aminwo witin kima'ibil. Qidmi misrah abi ra'iy zi'iwju merahiti nay himot desta
yisenqu gin ab mewedae'ita te'amannet yis'inu. Nihimya qidmi mitibba'e atsnie.)*

Scene 8

[PICTURE: Nehemiah standing before a large gathering of Jewish leaders, priests, and common people in the open square of ruined Jerusalem. His arms are spread wide as he speaks passionately. The people's faces shift from despair to hope as they listen. Behind him, the broken wall serves as a powerful visual reminder of why they must act. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Only after thorough preparation did Nehemiah reveal his vision. He gathered the Jewish officials, priests, and people and spoke with raw honesty: "You see the trouble we are in: Jerusalem lies in ruins, and its gates have been burned with fire. Come, let us rebuild the wall of Jerusalem, and we will no longer be in disgrace." He didn't minimize the problem or offer false optimism. He named the reality, then cast the vision. And critically, he shared his testimony: "I told them about the gracious hand of my God on me and what the king had said to me." He gave evidence that God was already at work. The people responded: "Let us start rebuilding." Vision plus evidence produces action.

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(Dihri atsebiqu midlaw tiray'yu Nihimya ra'iyu zigeletse. Nay Ayihud halafiti kahinat'n hizb'n akibu bitiri'u haqi tezarebe: "Nihna zilenayo tsegem tir'iyu alekhum, Iyerusalem inwet tekebiba degatata bihawi nedidu. Ni'u mendeq Iyerusalem nihants degim ab wirdet keynihlu." Tsegem ayinetseren wey hasewti tesfa ayihabn. Haqi teqisu dihri'u ra'iyu habe. Biwesani dima misikirnet'u akafele: "Biza'iba abay zinebere

tsega id Amlakhey'n nigus zibelenn'n negerkhwom." Amlak diro yisirih kem zinebere misikir habe. Hizbi "nihants nijimir" ilom melesu. Ra'iy mis misikir tegbar yifetir.)

serahteyntat ziqitsil kifal tsegnu. Serahti shitu negado agelgelti bete-meqdes — kulu seb nat'u imam nebero. Izi biluts sine-a'imro nebere: qereba gezakha kithants kelekha nay ketema mendeq tiray aykonkan tihants — nay geza'e sidrakha tiklakhel alekha. Srah biwilqi yikhewn. Bi'alnet ti'izaz fetsmu kifetro zeykhi'il dirkhit yifetir. Nihimya bitiqaq ayia'meren; seb ab zurya wilqawi wefri awedadibu dihiri'u natom kifal kigibru amenomu.)

Scene 10

[PICTURE: Two sneering men — Sanballat and Tobiah — standing on a hill overlooking the construction. They point and laugh mockingly at the workers below. Sanballat is richly dressed as a Samaritan governor, Tobiah as an Ammonite official. Their body language radiates contempt and arrogance. Workers below can hear the ridicule but continue working. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Opposition came immediately. Sanballat the Horonite, Tobiah the Ammonite official, and Geshem the Arab were furious that someone had come to promote the welfare of the Israelites. Their first weapon was mockery: "What is this you are doing? Are you rebelling against the king?" Then Tobiah added, sneering, "What they are building — even a fox climbing up on it would break down their wall of stones!" Ridicule is often the first weapon against any vision. It costs the attacker nothing but can devastate those who measure their worth by others' opinions. Opposition to good work is never random — those who benefit from brokenness will always resist restoration.

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(Teqawmo biqitsbet metse. Senbalat Horonawi Tobya Amonawi halaf'n Geshem
Areb'n hade seb nirebha deqi Isra'el kisirih mimtsa'u teqoti'om. Nay mejemreya
atswarom melagetsi nebere: "Izi tigibriwo zelekhum intay'yu? Ab li'ili nigus ti'eliwu

alekhum?" Tobya dima bimelagetsu wesekhe "Zihantswo zalewu — wekhara wala kidiyib nay a'iman mendeqom kefirsho'yu!" Melagetsi ab li'ili zikhone ra'iy bizuh gize nay mejemreya atsiwar'yu. Nimeitqa'i hanti ayikifllon gin wag'om biri'iy kal'ot niziqnu kitfi'e yikhil. Ab li'ili tsibuq srah zigber teqawmo fetsmu bi'agatami ayikonen — kab mibitakh teteqemti niqame kulu gize yiqawemu.)

dihri'u nab mendeq temelisu srah qetsele. "Silezi mendeq hanetsna kisab kulu firqi qumet'u betshe hizbi bimilu'e libomu sile ziserhu." Izi teqawmo nay mi'ilay abnet'yu: biza'ib'u tseli dihri'u bisrah si'aro. Nineqefeta milashka dimuq qalat zeyikone zi'abeye wits'it kikhewn alewo. Nizitewed'a mendeq melskha yikhun.)

wetehaderwi metqa'iti hasebu. Izi kitfilto zigibi'e abnet'yu: melagetsi dew zeyibileka mis kone teqawmo kisegir'yu. Kab qalat nab mifirrah kab mifirrah nab widit kab widit nab tegbar kisegageru'yom. Gin zisegir teqawmo dew kitbil aleka zibil milikti ayikonen — bizuh gize sirahkha nizelo kunet kiferarihi zi'akil wits'itawi mkhwanu misikir'yu. Tselai zeyiagedso ayqalesin.)

Scene 13

[PICTURE: Jewish workers building the wall with extraordinary determination. Each man holds a tool in one hand and a sword or spear in the other. Some have swords strapped to their sides while they lay bricks. A trumpeter stands ready on a high point. Guards watch the horizon. The scene captures the tension of working under constant threat of attack. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Nehemiah's response to military threats was both spiritual and practical: "We prayed to our God and posted a guard day and night." He didn't just pray and hope for the best — he prayed AND prepared. Half the men worked while the other half stood guard with spears, shields, and bows. Those who carried materials did their work with one hand and held a weapon in the other. Each builder wore a sword at his side as he worked. Nehemiah stationed a trumpeter beside him, ready to sound the alarm. This is not a lack of faith — this is faith that takes responsibility. God expects us to pray as if everything depends on Him and work as if everything depends on us, because both are true.

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(Niwetehaderwi mifirrah nay Nihimya milash menfesawi'n tegbarawi'n nebere: "Nab Amlakna tselena leyt'n me'alit'n halewa aqemetna." Tselihyu zibeletsee tesfa tiray aygeberen — tseleye kem'u'wun tedalwe. Firqi sebat zisirhu kelewo iti kal'e firqi

bi'ilamatat walatot'n qesit'n haliwomu dew belu. Nibret zitsewru bihanti id zisirhu bikhal'iti atsiwar zikhazu neberu. Nefsi wekef hanets'ti kisrih kelo ab gonu seyfi te'atiqu nebere. Nihimya godnu melekhet nefahi aqemetse nimtinqaq diluw. Izi nay imnet gudlet ayikonen — halafinet ziwesid imnet'yu. Amlak kulu ab'u kem zimirkos tselina kulu abana kem zimirkos kinserih yitsbeyna kiltiu haqi sile zikhone.)

Scene 14

[PICTURE: Inside Jerusalem, wealthy Jewish nobles confronting poor Jewish families. The rich men wear fine clothes and have arrogant postures. Poor families — thin, desperate mothers with hungry children — plead before them. Some hold documents showing debt. The contrast between the exploitation within the community is stark and painful. Nehemiah watches from nearby, his face darkening with righteous anger. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

While fighting external enemies, Nehemiah discovered an equally devastating threat from within. The poor among the Jews cried out against their own wealthy brothers. During the building project, food was scarce. Some families had mortgaged their fields and homes just to buy grain. Others had borrowed money to pay the king's tax and were being charged excessive interest by their own people. Some had even been forced to sell their children into slavery to fellow Jews. The very people building the wall together were exploiting each other. External threats are easier to address than internal injustice, because internal problems require you to confront your own community — people you eat with, worship with, and build beside.

[illegible]

(Nay dege tselai'ti kiqales kelo Nihimya bima'ire zeatfi'e nay wishiti sig'at rekebe. Ab mengo Ayihud dikhkatat antsara nay geza'e ri'isom habtamat ahwat tserhu. Ab iwan hintset migbi hidet nebere. Gele sidrabetat agirawtom'n gezawtom'n ihili nimigza'e ab ida a'itiyom. Kal'ot gibri nigus nimikhfal genzeb teleqihom binay geza'e hizbom zitigennene weled yihhitetu neberu. Gele deqom ninay geza'e Ayihud ahwat bibarnet kishetu tegeddom. Bihabara mendeq zihanitsu zineberu hizbi nenhadihddom yibezibzu neberu. Nay dege sig'atat kab nay wishiti amets nimi'ilay ziqelellu'yom nay wishiti tsegegmat nay geza'e mahiberkha — misakha zibelu misakha zimlekhu godnkha zihanitsu sebat — kitgetimomu sile zihattu.)

Scene 15

[PICTURE: Nehemiah standing before a large assembly of wealthy nobles and officials, his face burning with righteous anger. He points an accusing finger at the exploiters. The rich men look ashamed, shrinking back. Behind them, poor families watch with hope that justice will finally come. Nehemiah's authority and moral courage are palpable. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Nehemiah was furious — but he controlled his anger. Scripture says he "pondered" the situation before acting. Then he confronted the nobles and officials directly: "What you are doing is not right. Shouldn't you walk in the fear of our God to avoid the reproach of our enemies?" He didn't whisper behind their backs or send anonymous letters. He called a large meeting and publicly demanded they return the fields, vineyards, olive groves, and houses they had seized, along with the interest they had charged. True leaders don't ignore injustice because it's politically inconvenient. They address it head-on, even when the perpetrators are powerful people within their own ranks. A leader who only fights external battles while tolerating internal corruption is building on sand.

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(Nihimya teqoti'u — gin qut'e'u teqotsatsiru. Qidus tsihuf qidmi migbar kunetat "hasebe" yibil. Dihri'u nimekwanint'n halafiti'n biqetita getimomu: "Tigibriwo zelexhum qinu'e ayikonen. Kab neqefeta tselaitna nimidhhan ab firhat Amlakna kitimelaesus ayigba'akum'ndo?" Bidihri hiqo'om ayhashwen wey bisim-albo debdabe ayile'akhen. Abi akheba tsewi'u biwegi'awi zihazwo golagul'n atakkilti weyn'n atakkilti zeyt'n gezawt'n mis zihatetwo weled kimelsu hatete. Haqenya merahiti poletikawi sile zeyemchi amets ayris'un. Biqetita yigetmu wala'tom amets'ti ab wishiti derb'om hayalat sebat yikhunu. Nay dege wig'at tiray ziqales nay wishiti bilishwina zitsawer merahi ab hutsa'yu zihnats.)

(Nihimya kab kal'ot tsidqi tiray ayihatten — ar'aya kone. Ni12 amet kem mislenee nay higawi meselu zinebere nay mislenee migbi abel fetsmu ayihateten. Qidmi'u zineberu misleneetat nihizbi ninay geza'e biltsgin'om bikhebid gibri acheniqom neberu. Nihimya abeye. Nisu'n sebu'n meret kab mi'ikab ab mendeq serhu. Nefsi wekef me'alti 150 sebat ab ma'idu binatu wets'ai abli'u. "Ab'zi hizbi tsor sile zikhebede nimislenee zitemedebe migbi fetcime ayihatetikun" tsehafe. Kal'ot meswai'ti kikhflu zihatit ba'ilu gin ab biltsigna zinebir merihnet kulu gize ab mewedae'ita kiferis'yu. Nay Nihimya moralawi siltan kab zitekhafelo meswai'ti'yu zimitse — ba'ilu kitsewiiro diluw zeyikone tsor hizbu kitsewru fetsmu ayihateten.)

Scene 17

[PICTURE: A messenger arriving at the wall where Nehemiah works, carrying an ornate scroll with a seal. The messenger gestures toward the plain of Ono in the distance. Nehemiah barely looks up from his work, his expression firm and unmoved. Workers around him continue their tasks. The scroll represents the fourth such invitation — a persistent attempt at deception. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

With the wall nearing completion, Sanballat and Geshem tried a new tactic: deception disguised as diplomacy. They sent a message: "Come, let us meet together in one of the villages on the plain of Ono." It sounded reasonable — a peace meeting, a chance to talk. But Nehemiah recognized it for what it was: a trap to lure him away from the work, possibly to harm or kill him. They sent this invitation four times. Four times Nehemiah refused. Persistent enemies use persistent tactics. They count on wearing you down, on catching you in a moment of weakness or curiosity. Recognizing deception requires both spiritual discernment and the discipline to say no repeatedly, even when the invitation sounds flattering.

[illegible]

(Mendeq nimizzam kqerib kelo Senbalat'n Geshem'n hadish silti fetenu: bidiplomasi zitehab'a mitilal. Mel'ikhiti le'akhu: "Ni'a ab hade kab aditat golgol Ono nirakeb." Mikinuy yimesil nebere — nay selam rikib nay mizirrab idil. Gin Nihimya zikhono

feleto: kab srah nikisihbo minalbat'wun kigodiwo wey kiqetlo zitesherbe mefenterya. Nezi idime arba'ite gize le'akhu. Arba'ite gize Nihimya abeye. Tsinu'at tselai'ti tsinu'at silititat yiteqemu. Kidkimukha ab himot dikhkamka wey hirfanka kihizukha yiqotsru. Mitilal mijilat menfesawi miliketi'n degagimka ayfal nay mibal disiplin'n yihatit wala idime zehbin kimesil kelo.)

*kiwerd kelekhu sleminty srah dew yibil?" Iza hanti hareg nay hiwet tibeb tihaz.
Qedamay: abi sirhka intay mkhwanu filet. Kal'ay: "miwrad" kulu gize kem widqet
aymeslin — hade hade gize kem mikinuy akheba tsibuq idil zehbin idime yimesil.
Salsay: sukhu'e nihimaq neger ayfal mibal ayikonen; natka zeyikone nitsibuq neger
ayfal mibal'yu. Nay'ti abi tselai iti zefrihi ayikonen — iti tsibuq tiray'yu. Nihimya kab
nay Amlak imamu nitahti bizikhone neger keysihbo abeye.)*

Scene 19

[PICTURE: Sanballat's servant delivering an open letter to Nehemiah — deliberately unsealed so everyone nearby can read the false accusations. The letter accuses Nehemiah of planning rebellion against the king. Workers nearby look worried as they overhear the contents. Nehemiah reads it calmly, his face showing neither fear nor surprise, only steady resolve. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When four invitations failed, Sanballat sent a fifth message — this time an open letter, deliberately unsealed so everyone could read its contents. It accused Nehemiah of planning to rebel against Persia and set himself up as king. It was a lie designed to create fear and division. If the rumor reached King Artaxerxes, Nehemiah could be arrested or killed. This was political manipulation at its most dangerous — using false accusations to destroy a leader's reputation and paralyze them with fear of consequences. Nehemiah's response was characteristically direct: "Nothing like what you are saying is happening; you are just making it up out of your head." He named the lie, refused to dignify it with extended debate, and went back to work.

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(Arba'ite idime mis se'ane Senbalat hamishai mel'ikhiti le'akhe — izi gize kifut debdabe biqesed kulu seb tihizto'u kinibib bizey mahteim zitele'akhe. Ni'Nihimya antsara Faris amets kem zihhasib'n geza'e ri'isu nigus kigbir'n kem ziwitin kesese. Firhi'n mifillay'n nimiftar zitenedefee hasot nebere. Were nab nigus Artahshasta inte betshe Nihimya ki'iser wey kiqtel yikhil nebere. Izi ab zibeletsee hadegenynet'u poletikawi mitilal nebere — nay merahi sem nimifti'e'n bifrihi sa'iiben nimlimilas'n hasewti kisi mitiqam. Nay Nihimya milash kem kulu gize qettenya nebere: "Kenti tiblo zelekha hanti neger zikhewn zelo yelen; kab a'imrokha tiray tifebrikho alekha." Hasot alelye binewih kiti'e kibret kihibbo abeye nab srah temelse.)

(Zibeleetsee zitehalalkhe metqa'iti bizimesil mehaza abilu metse. Shema'iya zibehal seb — nebiy'ye zibil — qetelti lomi leyti yimetsu'yom sile zibele ni'Nihimya ab bete-meqdes kihba'e tsseqte. Nay irkineti halyot yimesil nebere. Gin Nihimya biqitsbet re'aye: "Kem'zi zibele seb kihadim'do? Kem'zi zibele seb hiyowet'u nimidhhan nab bete-meqdes ki'atu'do? Aykeydln!" Dihri'u Shema'iya ni'Nihimya kiferarho'n hati'at kiblo'n biToby'a'n Senbalat'n kem zite'asbe teredie — ab bete-meqdes mihiba'e higi Amlak mitihhas'n nimerihnet Nihimya mibilshaw'n mikhene. Zibelitsu hadegnya metqa'ititat kab gilutsat tselai'ti ayikunun zimeitsu; nay tselai ajenda hizom mehazut mesilom kab zimeitsu sebat'yom zimeitsu.)

(Kulu inqifat tetsawiru — melagetsi wetehaderwi mifirrah nay wishiti mibezibaz poletikawi mitilal hasewti nebiyat'n nay qitlet fetenetat'n — mendeq ab 52 me'alti tiray tezazeme. Nili'ili kifile zemen zeyiteke'le zimesil zinebere nimiftsam 52 me'alti. Nay weledotat hisret'n teqala'enet'n ziwkil zinebere inwet nay Amlak immunet'n nay seb qoratsnet'n bihabara nay ziserhu milikti kone. Ab kem'zi zeyelbo gize kem zitezazeme kebabi hagerai mis semi'a ferhu ri'ise-miti'imimman se'anu "mikinyat'u izi srah bihagez Amlakna kem zitefetseme sile zitereddu." Iti zeyiteke'le nay gize seleeda nay seb bilhat tiray milikti ayineberen — ni'arki yikhun nitselai zire'a ab'ti projekt nay Amlak atsab'e milikti nebere.)

kindey kem zitefu felitom bekeyu. Nihimya negerom: "Aytihazennu hagos Goyta haylkhum'yu." Zitsenihi lewti kab akalawi meserete-limi'at nila'ili kem zihatit felete — menfesawi meseret yihatit. Tsinu'e mendeq gin dikhum nefsi zelewa ketema ab mewedae'ita kab wishiti kitferis'ya. Nihimya sebnat nimhilaw mendeq hanetse dihari'u libi nimihlaw kidan hanetse.)

*qame abnet'yu: zitesbre tiray aytsgigin — nay hisret botatat nab nay kibri medrekhat
yiqyir. Nay zi'abeye si'iretka bota nay zidemerqe miwdaska medrekh kikhewn yikhil.)*

Scene 24

[PICTURE: Nehemiah standing on the completed wall at dawn, looking out over the restored city of Jerusalem. The sun rises behind him, casting a golden glow. Below, families go about their daily lives safely — children playing, merchants trading, priests entering the temple. The wall stretches strong and complete around them all. Nehemiah's face shows quiet satisfaction — not pride, but gratitude. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Looking back on Nehemiah's journey, we see the anatomy of transformational leadership. It began with a burden — news that broke his heart. It was founded on prayer — not as a ritual but as a relationship. It required courage — risking everything to ask the king. It demanded wisdom — inspecting privately before speaking publicly. It organized others — giving each person ownership of their portion. It persevered through opposition — mockery, threats, manipulation, and betrayal. It addressed injustice — even when the perpetrators were allies. It maintained focus — refusing to come down from the great work. And it gave God the glory — recognizing that the impossible timeline was divine, not human. Every element was essential. Remove any one, and the wall remains unbuilt.

[illegible]

(Nay Nihimya gu'izo nidihrit mis nitimit nay lewti merihnet akalat nir'i. Bitsor jemiru — libu zisebere zena. Ab tselot temesritu — kem sir'at zeyikone kem zimidna. Difret hatitu — ninigus nimihatat kulu mihadegu. Tibeb hatitu — biwegi'awi qidmi mizrab biwilqi mifitash. Kal'ot awedadibu — nefsi wekef seb nay geza'e kifalum bi'alnet mihab. Biteqawmo tseni'u — melagetsi mifirrah mitilal'n kihdet'n. Amets getrimu — wala amets'ti amahaza mis zikhonu. Sukhu'e haliyu — kab abi srah kiwerd abiyu. Ni'Amlak kibri hibu — zeyiteke'le nay gize seleeda nay Amlak'imber nay seb kem zeyikone felitu. Nefsi wekef akal adlayi nebere. Hade aligis mendeq keytihanse yiterif.)

Scene 25

[PICTURE: A modern teenager standing at a crossroads, looking at a vision board showing their "great work" — perhaps studying, building community, serving others. Around them, distractions pull in every direction — phones buzzing, social media notifications, peer pressure. But the teen's face shows Nehemiah-like determination, choosing focus over distraction. A translucent image of Nehemiah with his trowel and sword appears as inspiration beside them. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Nehemiah's story speaks directly to your life today. What is YOUR Jerusalem — the broken thing that God has placed on your heart to rebuild? What walls of injustice, ignorance, or apathy need your hands and your prayers? Like Nehemiah, you will face mockery from those who don't share your vision. You will face threats from those who benefit from brokenness. You will face deception from those who pretend to be friends. And you will face the constant temptation to "come down" — to abandon your great work for lesser things that seem urgent but aren't important. Remember: pray before you plan. Inspect before you inspire. Address internal problems, not just external threats. And when the distractions come — and they will come — say with Nehemiah: "I am doing a great work and cannot come down."

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*(Zanta Nihimya biqetita nab hiyowtka lomi yizareb. Natka Iyerusalem — Amlak
kithanso ab libkha zeqemeto zitesbre neger — intay'yu? Nay idka'n tselotkha'n
zihattu nay amets dinqurna'n nay zeymigdas'n mendeqat intay'yom? Kem Nihimya
ra'iyka kab zeyikaflu melagetsi kitgetim'ikha. Kab mibitakh teteqemti mifirrah
kitgetim'ikha. Mehazut mesilom kab zimeitsu mitilal kitgetim'ikha. Kem'u'wun
"nimiwrad" — abi sirhakha gedifka hitsuts zimesil gin zeyegedis nizked neger —
qetsali fetena kitgetim'ikha. Zekir: qidmi miwtan tseli. Qidmi mitibba'e atsn'e. Nay
wishiti tsegamat teredayom nay dege sig'atat tiray zeyikone. Misihab mis zimetse'e —
kimetse'e'wun'yu — mis Nihimya bel: "Abi srah yisrih alekhu kiwerd aykhilin.")*

— Nehemiah 6:3

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4. The wall was completed in 52 days, and enemies "realized this work had been done with the help of God." Have you ever accomplished something where even skeptics had to acknowledge God's involvement? What does it look like when God's fingerprint is on your work versus when you're just operating in your own strength?

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5. Nehemiah modeled servant leadership — refusing the governor's allowance, feeding 150 people daily at his own expense, and working alongside the builders. In today's culture that celebrates celebrity leaders and personal platforms, what does genuine servant leadership look like in your generation? How can you lead by shared sacrifice rather than positional authority?

5. ፳፻፱ ፳፻ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻ — ፳፻ ፳፻፱ ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ 150 ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፱ ፳፻ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፱ ፳፻ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱? ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱፱፱፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱?

Prayer / ማጽናት

Dear God, thank You for the example of Nehemiah — a leader who prayed before he planned, who wept before he worked, and who gave You glory for every accomplishment. Lord, show me the broken walls You want me to help rebuild. Give me the courage to speak up, the wisdom to prepare thoroughly, and the focus to say "I cannot come down" when distractions try to pull me away from Your calling. Help me to address injustice within my own community, not just point at problems outside. Teach me that opposition is not a reason to quit but often a sign that my work matters. And when the wall is complete, let everyone know — friend and enemy — that it was done with the help of my God. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 53 of 60

"I am doing a great work and cannot come down."

"፲፱ ፲፱ ፲፱፱ ፲፱ ፲፱፱ ፲፱፱፱፱፱"

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